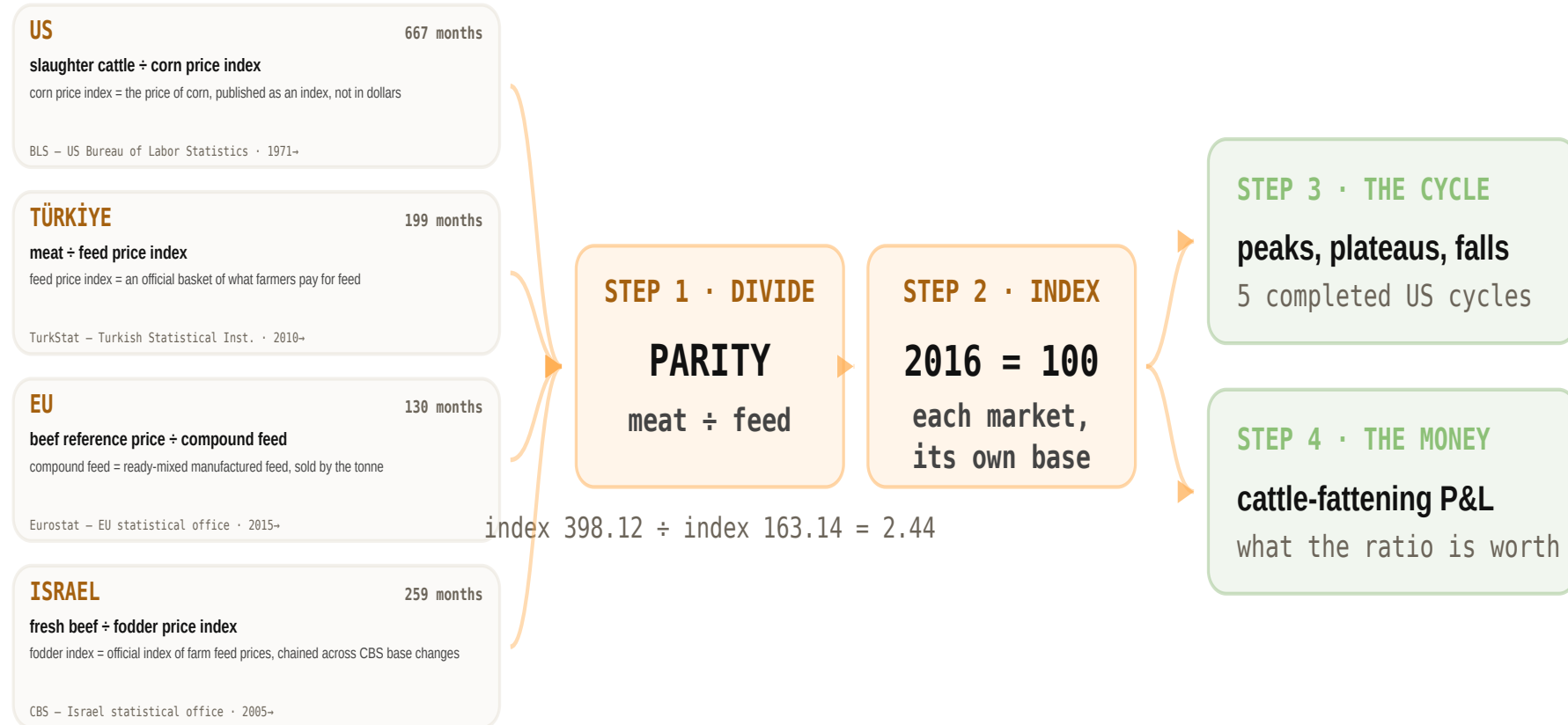


55 years of US data. 21 of Israel. 16 of Türkiye. 11 of the EU.

Eight published price series — every monthly observation each country has — turned into one comparable measure of what a producer earns, then read for its cycle. A feed price index is an official basket of what farmers pay for feed, published as an index rather than in lira or euros. Compound feed is ready-mixed manufactured feed — grain, protein and minerals in a finished ration, sold by the tonne.

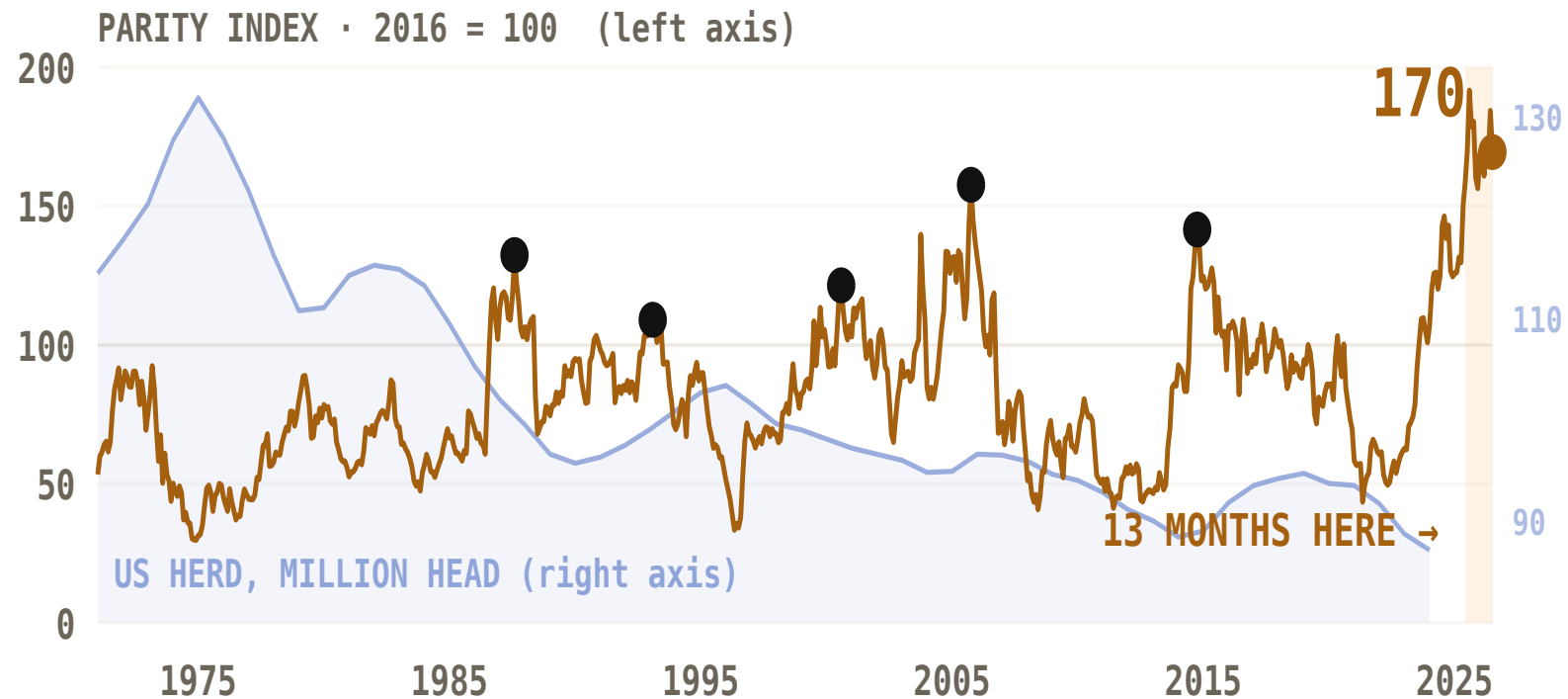


Three markets are at a cycle peak. Israel has just left its trough.

+70%_{US} **+22%**_{EU} **+20%**_{TR} **-16%**_{IL}

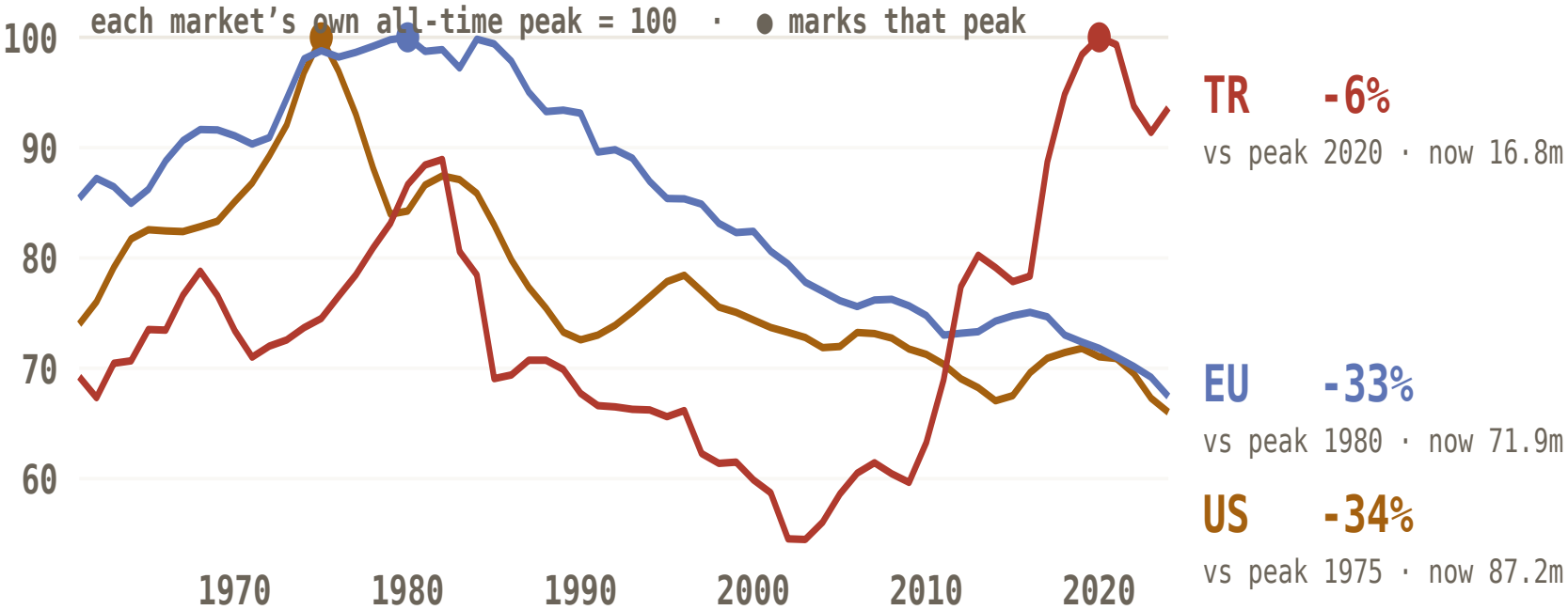
more (or less) feed a kilo of beef buys than in 2016 — each market against its own past. Israel sits below its 2016 level but exactly at its long-run mean, freshly recovered from the 2023 trough.

Chart: US only — record margins, fewest cattle since 1971. Amber = margin ratio (left), blue = the herd (right) — scarcity is what makes the margin. Relative measure: read it against its own past, never as a quantity of feed.



Two herds down a third. One still growing.

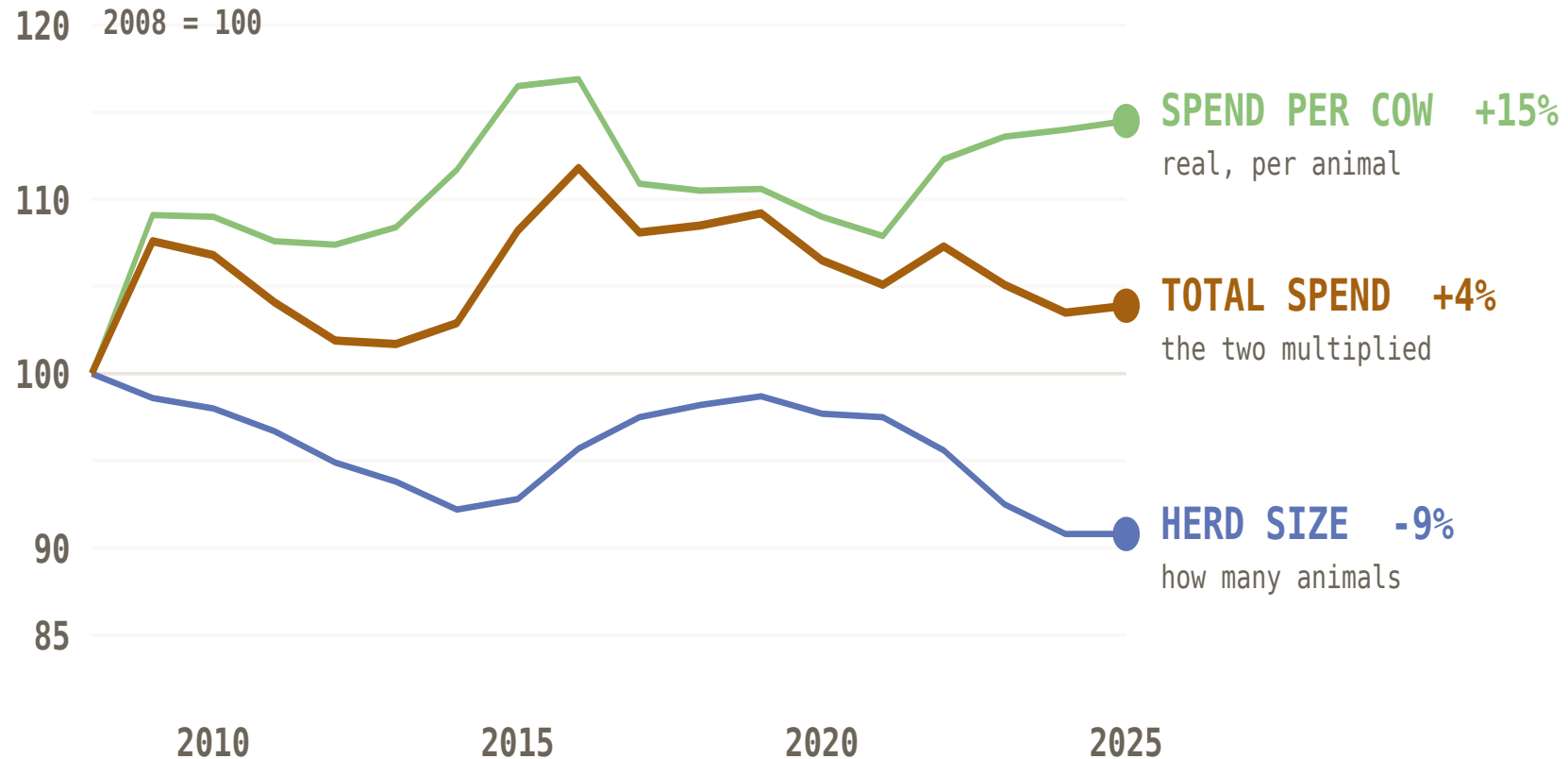
Cattle numbers, each market against its own all-time peak. Margin is measured per animal — this is how many animals there are.



These counts include dairy and beef animals together — FAOSTAT reports all cattle. Parity, by contrast, is a beef measure throughout. That matters most for the EU, where a large part of the decline is dairy restructuring (fewer, higher-yielding cows, accelerating after quotas ended in 2015) rather than the beef cycle. The US herd is predominantly beef, so its line is the closest match to the parity line. Series ends 2024; FAOSTAT publishes with roughly an 18-month lag.

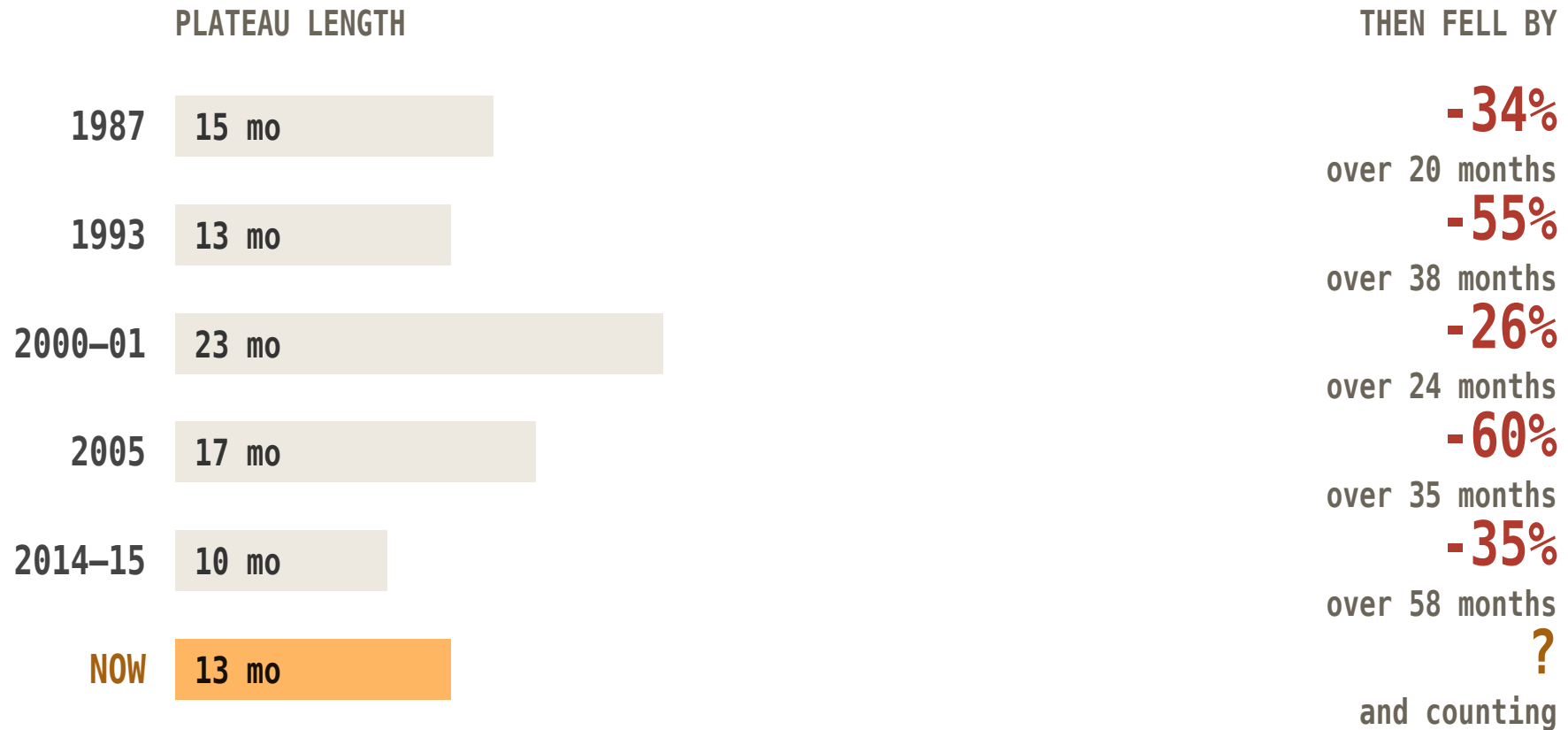
More per animal. Fewer animals. Total flat.

US cow-calf vet & medicine spending, inflation-adjusted. Per animal it rises with the margin ($r = +0.70$) — the shrinking herd cancels it out.



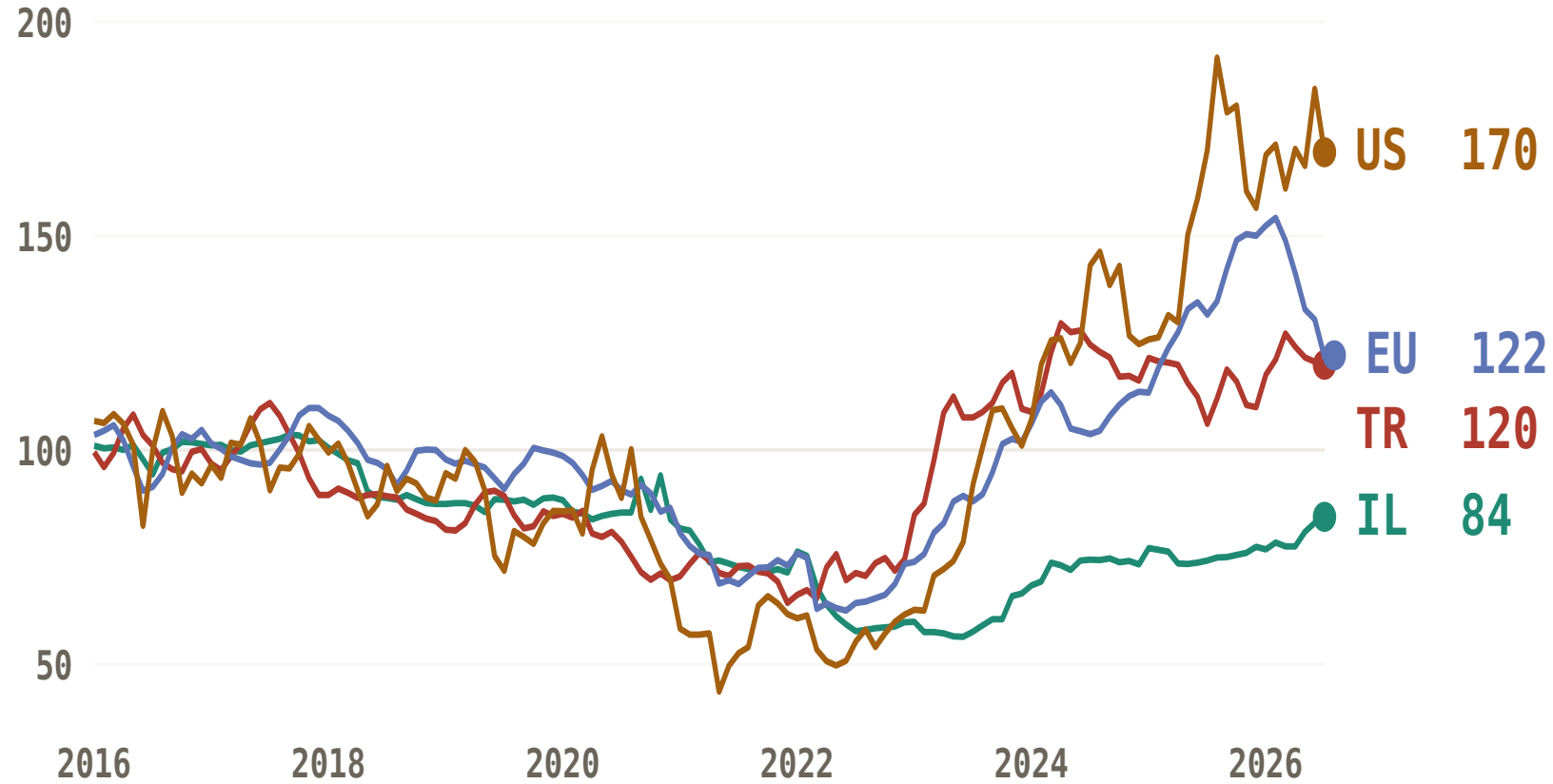
Five US peaks. Every one fell 25–60% — over two to five years.

US cycles, 1971–2026 — the only record long enough to count them. Peaks and falls measured on the twelve-month average, so single-month spikes do not count as cycles.



Four markets. One cycle. At the same time.

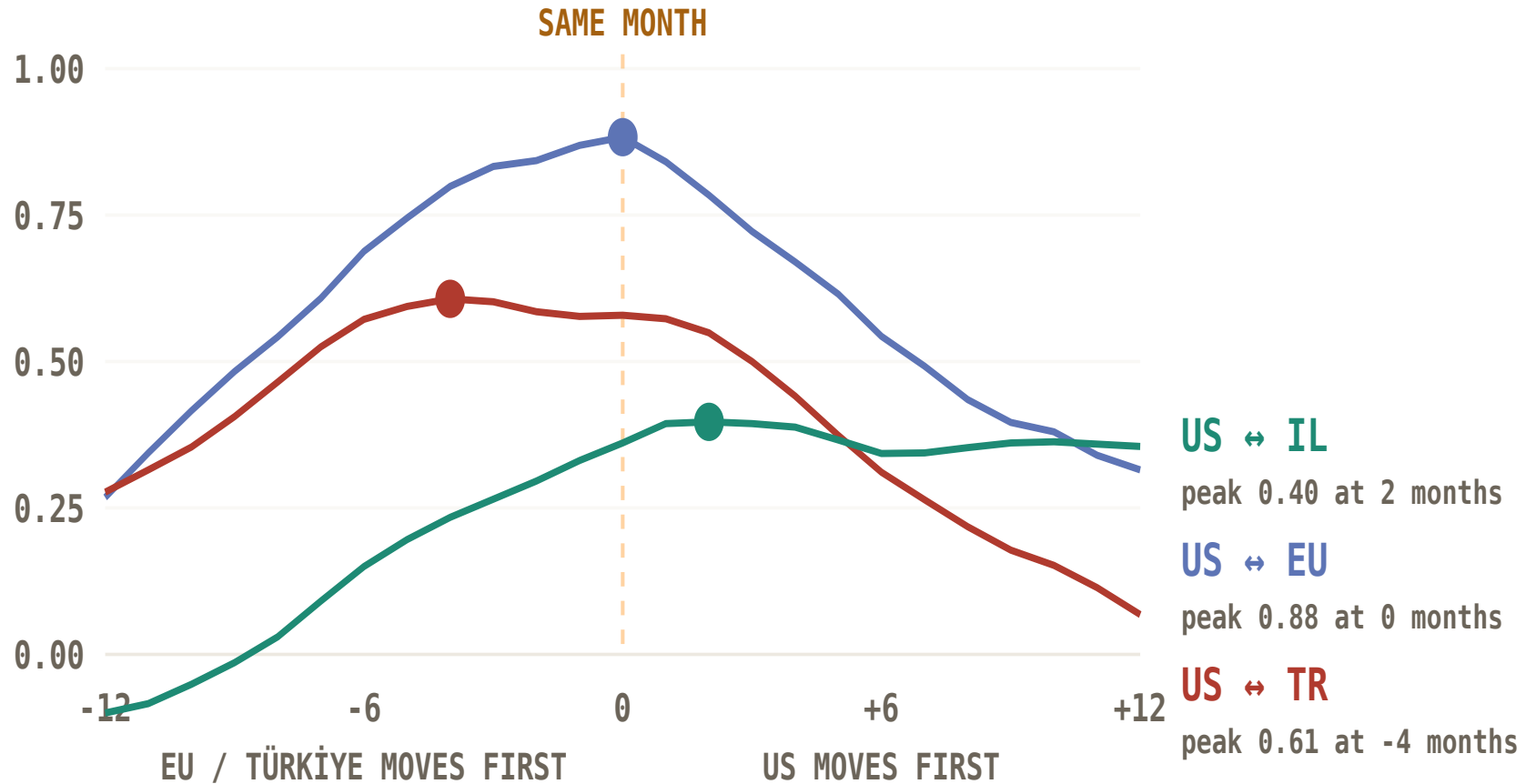
Now all four — each on its own 2016 = 100 base. Watch the shape, not the gap: levels are not comparable, timing is. The last year diverges — the US is still high while the EU cools and Israel sits back at its mean — because each herd rebuilds on its own schedule.



EACH MARKET INDEXED TO ITS OWN 2016 AVERAGE = 100 • CHART STARTS 2016: FIRST YEAR ALL FOUR SERIES EXIST • EU IS THE 27-MEMBER AGGREGATE • ISRAEL: BEEF PPI + FODDER INDEX, BASE-CHAINED

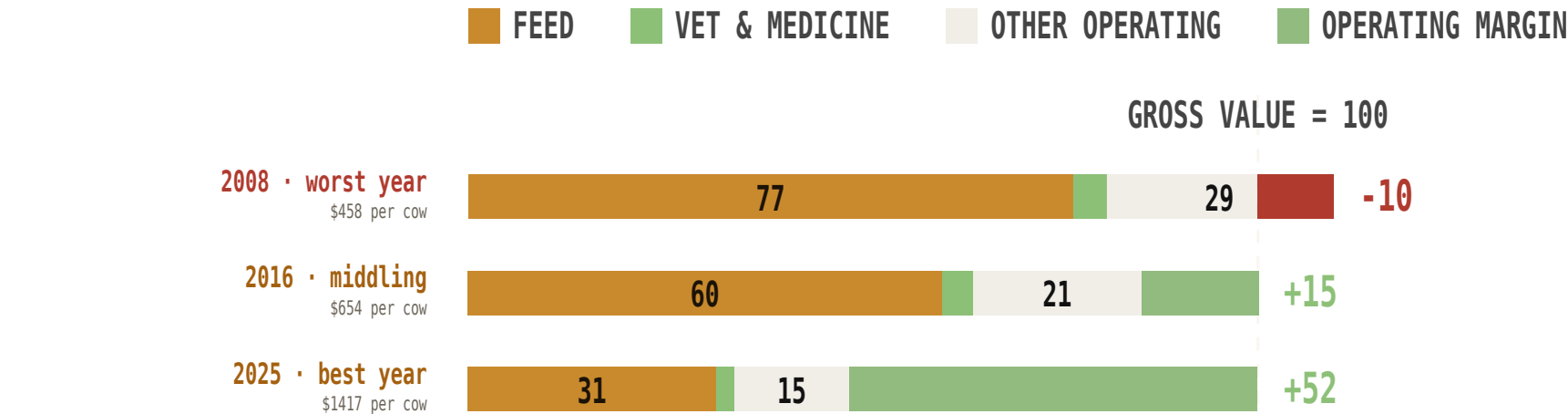
Yes for the big three — and nobody goes first. Israel rhymes, loosely.

Correlation of year-on-year change, tested at every shift from -12 to +12 months. A market that led would peak clearly off-centre. The EU peaks exactly at zero; Türkiye is flat across -4 to 0. Israel co-moves only moderately (peak $r = 0.40$) — the same grain shocks arrive, but through a smoother fodder index and a domestic beef market.



Feed was 77% of revenue. Now it is 31%.

USDA's own cow-calf accounts, per \$100 of gross value. Nothing modelled — these are surveyed costs. The feed line does the swinging; vet spend barely moves.



Operating margin, not profit — excludes overhead, unpaid family labour and capital recovery (USDA costs these at ~¾ of gross value). Cow-calf, not feedlot, so no calf-purchase line.

EVERY SOURCE IN THIS DECK

Meat & feed prices

US: BLS producer price indexes WPU0131 (slaughter cattle) ÷ WPU012202 (corn), via FRED, 1971 →
EU: European Commission beef reference price ÷ feed grain, 2015 →
Türkiye: TurkStat Yi-ÜFE TP.TUFE1YI.T17 ÷ T25, via CBRT EVDS, 2010 →
Israel: CBS index API 190030 (fresh beef PPI) ÷ 260030 (fodder input index), base-chained across CBS rebasings, 2005 → . Pair choice robustness-checked against the TR-parallel pair 180073÷180195: r = 0.96 in levels, 0.89 in annual changes.

Cattle numbers

FAOSTAT cattle stocks (head), via Our World in Data, 1961–2024, all three markets

Veterinary spend

US: USDA ERS commodity costs and returns, cow-calf, 1996 →
EU: Eurostat Economic Accounts for Agriculture, item AM205000, 2005 →

Deflators

US: CPI-U (FRED CPIAUCSL) · Euro area: HICP (FRED CP0000EZ19M086NEST)

Breaks & limits

ERS changed survey basis in 2008 — no comparison spans it. EU veterinary line covers all livestock, not cattle alone. No per-head cost accounts published for Türkiye.

Four markets. Four different instructions.

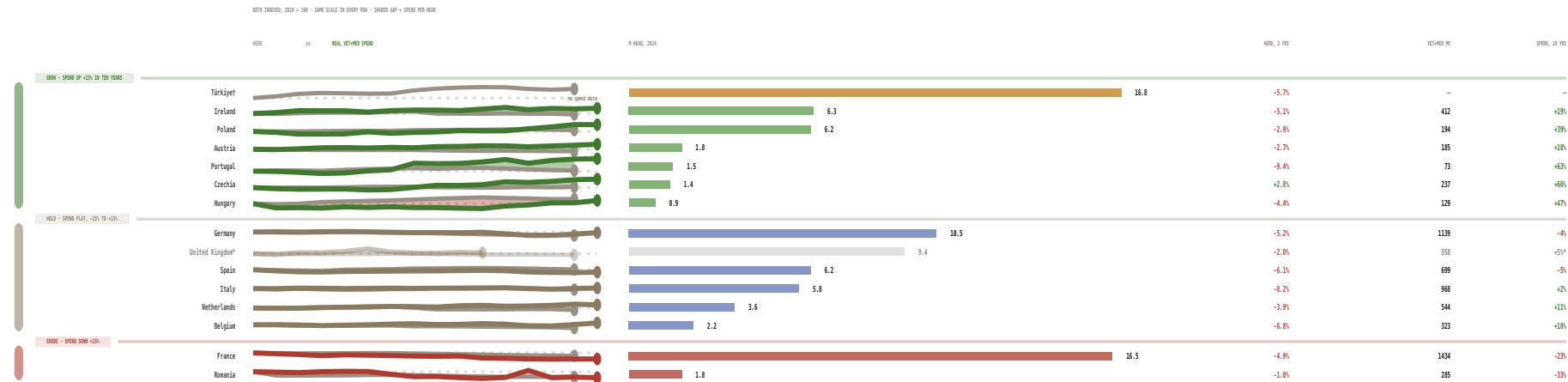
Same cycle everywhere, three different consequences. The US is a timing problem. The EU is a volume problem. Türkiye is a visibility problem. Israel is the benchmark.

US	EU	TÜRKİYE	ISRAEL
HOW MANY ANIMALS	HOW MANY ANIMALS	HOW MANY ANIMALS	HOW MANY ANIMALS
 -34%	 -33%	 -6%	—
vs peak · now 87m · bottom 2024s	vs peak · now 72m · -1.4%/yr	vs peak · now 17m · +2.4%	no herd series in this deck
SPEND vs MARGINcyclical	SPEND vs MARGIN flat	SPEND vs MARGIN no data	SPEND vs MARGIN no data
 r = 0.70	 r = 0.00	 —	 —
THE MONEY IN THE MARKET +4% 17-yr real pool	THE MONEY IN THE MARKET -5% 20-yr real pool	THE MONEY IN THE MARKET n/a not measurable	THE MONEY IN THE MARKET n/a not measurable
TIME THE PRICE MOVE	DEFEND THE VOLUME	GROW, AND GET VISIBILITY	USE AS THE BENCHMARK
Margin per cow ran \$22 to \$732 while vet fell to 2.34% of revenue, an 18-year low. The opening is price, not volume.	2027 is not a bad year — it is the same year, ~1.5% smaller. No cycle upside, no cycle hit; the herd erodes regardless.	2027 is the only market where head count adds to volume — and the only one where we cannot see what producers spend.	Calmeist parity in the panel (×1.8 vs the US ×6.4), freshly mean-reverted — the region's cleanest baseline for cycle risk.

HERD: FAOSTAT · SPEND SENSITIVITY = CORRELATION OF REAL VET SPEND PER HEAD WITH PRODUCER MARGIN · US MARGIN = GROSS VALUE OF PRODUCTION LESS OPERATING COSTS PER COW, USDA ERS COW-CALF, REAL 2025 DOLLARS, 2022 AND 2025 · VET SHARE = VETERINARY AND MEDICINE OVER GROSS VALUE OF PRODUCTION; 2.34% IS THE LOWEST OF THE 2008–2025 SERIES, WHICH RANGES 2.34–4.88% · NO PER-HEAD COSTS PUBLISHED FOR TR

Every herd is shrinking. Only the spending separates them.

Per country, two lines on one scale: the herd and real vet+med spend, each indexed to 100 in 2010. The gap between them is spend per head. Fourteen of the fifteen herds are smaller than three years ago — only Czechia grew, and Hungary, Poland and Czechia did all their ten-year growth before 2020. No volume growth is available anywhere in 2027 — but in six markets the green line still climbs away from the grey.



The 2027 price call. Every herd here is contracting, so the increase comes from price and spend per head, not volume. **Grow** — Czechia, Portugal, Hungary, Poland, Ireland, Austria: real spend rose +18% to +66% while herds tightened. Take the full increase. **But size the prize honestly:** those six are **19% of EU vet+med spend** — France alone is bigger than all six combined, which is why the EU verdict on slide 9 is still defend. **Hold** — Germany, Netherlands, Belgium, Italy, Spain: spend steady, herds not. Price carries the number. **Erode** — France, Romania: -23% and -33%. Defend share, do not lead on price. **Türkiye is not an EU market** and is not in the Eurostat accounts — largest herd on the page, the only decade of herd growth, no spend series at all. Grow it, and get the visibility. **United States (slides 2–5):** take the full increase in January and hold it through 2028 — do not make it flexible. This is the one market where the move is proven to survive the turn: in 2016 the producer margin fell **73%** and real spend per head still rose **+0.3%**; the worst year in eighteen is -5.1%. And do not price for volume — **+81% margin bought +2% spend**.

HERD: FAOSTAT, ALL CATTLE, DAIRY+BEEF, ANNUAL TO 2024 • SPEND: EUROSTAT EAA “VETERINARY EXPENSES” = VET SERVICES + MEDICINES, ALL LIVESTOCK NOT CATTLE ALONE, TO 2025 • BOTH LINES INDEXED TO 100 IN 2010; EVERY ROW USES THE SAME INDEX-POINTS-PER-PIXEL (84 POINTS FULL HEIGHT) BUT IS CENTRED ON ITS OWN DATA, SO SLOPES ARE COMPARABLE ACROSS ROWS; DOTTED LINE = 100, DOT = LATEST YEAR; SHADED GAP = REAL SPEND PER HEAD, GREEN WHERE SPEND OUTRUNS THE HERD • SPEND DEFLATED BY EURO-AREA HICP (APPROX. FOR NON-EURO PL/RO/CZ/HU) • HERD 3 YRS = 2021–2024, SAME SIGN ON A 5-YEAR WINDOW FOR ALL FIFTEEN • A 3-YEAR REAL SPEND FIGURE IS NOT SHOWN: THE 2022–23 INFLATION SPIKE FLIPS ITS SIGN WITH THE BASE YEAR • SHARE-OF-SPEND WEIGHTS FROM 2025 LEVELS, 13 MEMBER STATES, UK EXCLUDED • *UK SPEND SERIES ENDS 2020 • †NO SPEND SOURCE FOR TÜRKİYE • THE 13 EU MEMBER-STATE ROWS = 90% OF THE EU27 HERD; UK AND TÜRKİYE ARE NOT EU AND ARE EXCLUDED FROM EVERY EU TOTAL • US IS ON A DIFFERENT SPEND SOURCE (USDA ERS, \$/COW) AND IS NOT COMPARABLE HERE • US FIGURES IN THE PRICE CALL: USDA ERS COW-CALF, US TOTAL, REAL 2025 DOLLARS, 2008–2025 • MARGIN = GROSS VALUE OF PRODUCTION LESS OPERATING COSTS PER COW (\$480 IN 2015 TO \$130 IN 2016) • -5.1% IS THE LARGEST SINGLE-YEAR REAL FALL IN SPEND PER HEAD IN THE SERIES (2017) • +81%/+2% IS 2022–2025